

Legal Ease

Workflow Epics

Epics, user stories and acceptance criteria from intake to file closing

Document type	Product backlog: epics
Version	1.0 (Draft)
Status	For review

1. Epic Summary

The Legal Ease workflow is broken into nine epics that follow a matter through its life, plus one cross-cutting epic for security and audit. Story points are rough estimates for planning and should be refined with the team.

Epic	Name	Priority	Release
E1	Client Intake	P1	R1
E2	Conflict Check	P1	R1
E3	Engagement and Retainer	P1	R2
E4	Matter Setup and Deadlines	P1	R2
E5	Research and Drafting	P1	R2
E6	Review and Approval	P2	R3
E7	Filing and Service	P2	R3
E8	Time and Billing	P1	R3
E9	Matter Closing and Archive	P2	R4
E10	Security, Access and Audit	P1	R1 onward

Priority key: P1 = launch-critical, P2 = important, P3 = later.

E1: Client Intake

Priority	P1
Description	Capture new client and matter information in a structured, consistent way.
Business value	Faster onboarding, fewer missing details, clean data for every later stage.
Dependencies	None (first epic in the workflow)

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E1-1	As an admin, I want to record client details (individual or organization) so that every matter starts from a complete profile.	3
E1-2	As an attorney, I want intake forms specific to each practice area so that I collect the right facts up front.	5
E1-3	As a prospective client, I want to submit my details through a secure online form so that I do not need to email documents.	5
E1-4	As an admin, I want to record matter type, key dates and deadlines at intake so that nothing is missed.	3

Acceptance criteria

- Required fields are enforced before an intake can be submitted.
- Intake data creates or updates a client and a draft matter.
- Duplicate client records are flagged before saving.

E2: Conflict Check

Priority	P1
Description	Screen every new party against existing clients, matters and opposing parties.
Business value	Meets ethical duties and prevents costly conflicts of interest.
Dependencies	E1

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E2-1	As an admin, I want conflicts checked automatically at intake so that no matter opens without screening.	5

ID	Story	Points
E2-2	As an attorney, I want fuzzy matching on names and aliases so that near matches are not missed.	8
E2-3	As a partner, I want to review, clear or decline a conflict with notes so that decisions are recorded.	5
E2-4	As a compliance officer, I want a stored conflict report per matter so that I can show what was checked.	3

Acceptance criteria

- A matter cannot be opened until the check is cleared or waived by an authorized user.
- Every result and decision is saved with user and time.
- Search covers clients, related parties and opposing parties.

E3: Engagement and Retainer

Priority	P1
Description	Generate, send and sign engagement letters and fee agreements, and collect the retainer.
Business value	Shorter time to start work and a signed record for every engagement.
Dependencies	E1, E2

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E3-1	As an attorney, I want engagement letter templates by matter type so that letters are consistent.	5
E3-2	As a client, I want to sign the agreement electronically so that I can start quickly.	8
E3-3	As an admin, I want to request and track the retainer payment so that work starts only when funded.	5
E3-4	As an admin, I want to see engagement status (draft, sent, signed, expired) so that I can follow up.	3

Acceptance criteria

- Signed copy is saved to the matter automatically with a timestamp.
- Retainer payment is linked to the correct account and matter.
- Reminders are sent for unsigned agreements.

E4: Matter Setup and Deadlines

Priority	P1
Description	Open the matter file, assign the team and calendar all critical dates.
Business value	Prevents missed deadlines, the highest-risk failure in a law practice.
Dependencies	E2, E3

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E4-1	As an admin, I want to open a matter with team, responsible attorney and folder structure so that work is organized.	5
E4-2	As an attorney, I want deadlines calculated from a trigger date using configurable rules so that dates are accurate.	13
E4-3	As a team member, I want reminders by email and in-app so that I act before dates pass.	5
E4-4	As a user, I want two-way sync with Google and Outlook calendars so that I use one schedule.	8
E4-5	As a partner, I want escalation when a critical deadline is at risk so that I can step in.	5

Acceptance criteria

- Calculated deadlines require attorney confirmation before they are final.
- Every deadline has an owner and reminder schedule.
- Calendar sync updates within a few minutes of a change.

E5: Research and Drafting

Priority	P1
Description	Gather documents, do research and produce drafts from templates.
Business value	Reduces repetitive drafting time and improves consistency.
Dependencies	E4

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E5-1	As a paralegal, I want to upload and organize documents by matter so that everything is in one place.	5

ID	Story	Points
E5-2	As an associate, I want to generate a draft from a template using matter data so that I skip retyping.	8
E5-3	As a user, I want version history on every document so that I can see and restore earlier drafts.	5
E5-4	As a user, I want full-text search and OCR on scanned files so that I can find content quickly.	8
E5-5	As a partner, I want to restrict access to sensitive matters so that ethical walls are enforced.	5

Acceptance criteria

- Generated drafts fill all available merge fields and flag missing ones.
- Every save creates a version with author and time.
- Restricted documents are hidden from excluded users.

E6: Review and Approval

Priority	P2
Description	Route documents for attorney review and client sign-off with a clear audit trail.
Business value	Better quality control and fewer errors leaving the firm.
Dependencies	E5

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E6-1	As an associate, I want to send a draft to a reviewer with a due date so that review is tracked.	3
E6-2	As a reviewer, I want inline comments and tracked changes so that feedback is precise.	8
E6-3	As an attorney, I want to compare two versions side by side so that I see what changed.	5
E6-4	As a client, I want to approve a document in the portal so that sign-off is recorded.	5

Acceptance criteria

- Document states move through draft, in review, approved and sent.
- Approvals record who approved, when and which version.
- Only approved versions can be filed or sent.

E7: Filing and Service

Priority	P2
Description	Prepare, file and serve documents with the court, agency or other parties.
Business value	Fewer filing errors and a complete proof of service on file.
Dependencies	E4, E5, E6

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E7-1	As a paralegal, I want a filing package (main document, exhibits, cover sheet) assembled in order so that filing is complete.	8
E7-2	As a paralegal, I want to preview and export the package in the required format so that the court accepts it.	8
E7-3	As an attorney, I want to record filing date, method and confirmation so that the record is complete.	3
E7-4	As a paralegal, I want to record service details and proof of service so that compliance is documented.	5

Acceptance criteria

- Filing confirmation and proof of service are saved to the matter.
- Filing dates automatically trigger dependent deadlines.
- Court format presets are configurable and verified against current local rules.

E8: Time and Billing

Priority	P1
Description	Track time, generate invoices, manage trust funds and collect payment.
Business value	Improves billing accuracy and speeds up collections.
Dependencies	E3, E4

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E8-1	As a lawyer, I want timers and quick time entry tied to matters so that I capture all billable work.	5

ID	Story	Points
E8-2	As an admin, I want invoices generated on a schedule from time entries so that billing is consistent.	8
E8-3	As a partner, I want to review and adjust invoices before sending so that I control what clients see.	5
E8-4	As an accountant, I want a trust ledger with reconciliation so that client funds are handled correctly.	13
E8-5	As a client, I want to pay online so that invoices are settled faster.	8
E8-6	As an admin, I want automatic payment reminders so that I spend less time chasing.	3

Acceptance criteria

- Invoices reconcile to time entries and fixed fees.
- Trust balances are tracked per client and cannot go negative without an alert.
- Payments update the ledger and invoice status automatically.

E9: Matter Closing and Archive

Priority	P2
Description	Close the matter properly, return originals and archive the file with a retention date.
Business value	Meets record retention duties and keeps the active caseload clean.
Dependencies	E7, E8

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E9-1	As an attorney, I want a closing checklist so that no step is skipped.	3
E9-2	As an admin, I want to generate a closing letter from a template so that the client is formally notified.	3
E9-3	As an admin, I want to export the full matter file as a bundle so that I can deliver or store it.	8
E9-4	As a compliance officer, I want retention dates set and flagged for review so that files are kept and destroyed correctly.	5

Acceptance criteria

- A matter cannot be closed with unpaid invoices or open trust balances without an override.
- Closed matters become read-only.
- Retention date is set at closing and triggers a review alert.

E10: Security, Access and Audit

Priority	P1
Description	Protect client data and keep a complete record of activity across the platform.
Business value	Preserves privilege, meets compliance duties and builds client trust.
Dependencies	Applies across E1 to E9

User stories

ID	Story	Points
E10-1	As an admin, I want role-based access so that users see only what they should.	8
E10-2	As a user, I want multi-factor authentication so that accounts are protected.	5
E10-3	As a compliance officer, I want an audit log of views, edits, exports and sharing so that activity is traceable.	8
E10-4	As an admin, I want encryption in transit and at rest so that data is protected.	5

Acceptance criteria

- All sensitive actions are logged with user, time and item.
- Access changes take effect immediately.
- Audit logs cannot be edited by regular users.

Release Plan

Release	Epics	Outcome
R1	E1, E2, E10	Secure intake and conflict screening
R2	E3, E4, E5	Engagement, deadlines and drafting
R3	E6, E7, E8	Review, filing and billing
R4	E9 and refinements	Closing, archive and retention

Note: Story points and priorities are initial estimates. Deadline rules, filing formats and trust accounting must be verified against local requirements.